

Chapter 9

Do What It Takes Millionaires Are Hard Workers

As we've poured through our research on America's millionaires, we haven't seen any big educational or intellectual advantages. We have not seen huge inheritances or lottery payouts. We haven't seen crazy, strike-it-rich, once-in-a-lifetime, risky investments. You know what we have seen? Work. Lots and lots of meticulous, often grueling and gritty, dirt-under-the-fingernails, nose-to-the-grindstone, hard work. Wherever they are and whatever they're doing, these men and women work with intensity—and all that hard work has paid off.

Have you noticed how many of the millionaire stories we've seen in this book contain the word *farm*? I have. I swear, it seems like every other millionaire we've featured grew up on a farm. I don't think that's an accident. There's no such thing as a lazy farmer. Farms require you to put in the work day in and day out. If you stop or even slow down, you could ruin whole crops. You could end up with nothing to sell—or eat. A farm background develops the solid, lifelong work ethic that's required to build wealth. I understand that; I actually worked on a farm myself when I was a teenager. I bailed and loaded hay, worked in the barn, and kept up the property for a huge farm back in Kentucky. I remember taking the weed trimmer to a mile-long stretch of fence in one pasture, knowing I'd have another, bigger pasture to deal with the next day. The work never stopped, and if I slowed down, I knew all that work would overtake me. But at the